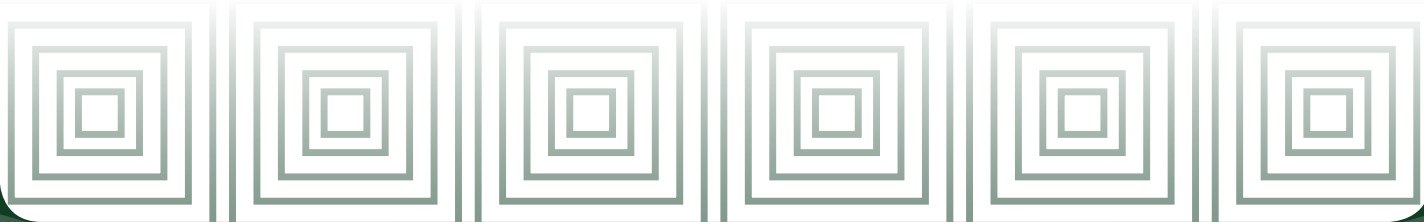


PSYCHOLOGY SYLLABUS FOR LANGUAGES PATHWAY

UPPER SECONDARY SCHOOLS (S4-S6)

Kigali, 2026



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FOREWORD

The Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB) is honored to present the second edition of the Upper Secondary Level Psychology syllabus (S4–S6). It serves as an official guide for competence-based teaching and learning within the Languages pathway, ensuring consistency in delivering quality education across the country. It supports the implementation of the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC) and reflects Rwanda’s commitment to nurturing students’ knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes.

Quality education is the foundation of Rwanda’s sustainable development and prosperity. Aligned with the national education philosophy, this syllabus promotes critical thinking, creativity, inclusiveness, and holistic student development. It aims to empower young people with competences necessary to achieve full potential, equipping them with relevant knowledge, skills, the right attitudes and values to integrate effectively into society and pursue opportunities in a competitive world.

Anchored in Rwanda Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2), this syllabus supports the nation’s goal of building a knowledge-based economy driven by innovation, resilience, and global competitiveness. It prioritizes learner-centred pedagogy, active learning, and the practical application of knowledge to prepare student not only for academic success but also to become responsible, ethical, and productive citizens capable of contributing to Rwanda’s continued transformation.

This syllabus reflects our determination to equip students with 21st-century skills, foster innovation, and instill values of integrity, social responsibility, and lifelong learning. Its success depends largely on the dedication and professionalism of teachers and school leaders. We therefore call upon all educators to embrace the approaches, methodologies, and assessment strategies outlined herein with commitment and passion, transforming classrooms into dynamic spaces of curiosity, creativity, and inspiration.

On behalf of REB, I extend my heartfelt appreciation to all who contributed to the development of this syllabus. Your expertise and dedication have been instrumental in shaping a curriculum that meets the needs of our students. Together, we can ensure that education continues to be a powerful driver of our nation's development and prosperity.



Dr. MBARUSHIMANA Nelson

Director General, Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB)

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The development of this syllabus has been a collective effort that reflects the dedication, expertise, and commitment of many stakeholders. On behalf of the Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources Department of the Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB), I wish to express my deepest appreciation to all who contributed to the successful preparation of the Upper Secondary Level Psychology Syllabus for Languages Pathway (S4–S6).

Special thanks go to the subject experts, curriculum developers, teachers, and education partners whose insights, feedback, and professional contributions have been invaluable in shaping this syllabus. Your collaboration has ensured that the syllabus is not only aligned with Rwanda's Competence-Based Curriculum but also responsive to the aspirations of Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2).

We also acknowledge the invaluable support of development partners and education stakeholders who have consistently provided technical assistance in curriculum adaptation. Your partnership has greatly contributed to strengthening the quality of Rwanda's education system.

Finally, we call upon teachers, school leaders, and all education practitioners to use this syllabus with commitment and professionalism, ensuring that classrooms become vibrant learning environments that nurture knowledge, skills, values, and positive attitudes among learners. Through your dedication, this syllabus will fulfil its purpose of empowering learners to realize their full potential and contribute meaningfully to Rwanda's sustainable development.



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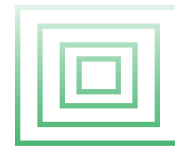
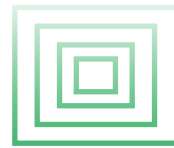
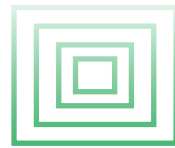
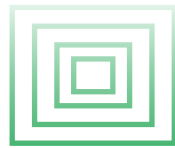
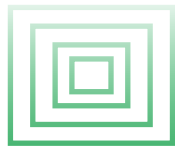
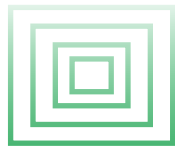
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General Introduction



1. General Introduction

1.1. Background to the syllabus adaptation

The adaptation of Upper Secondary school *Psychology Syllabus for Languages Pathway* reflects Rwanda's ongoing commitment to strengthening the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC), first rolled out in 2015. Continuous feedback from teachers, school leaders, and education partners highlighted the need for improvements in content delivery, time allocation, and responsiveness to student needs.

This edition incorporates the Ministerial directive to harmonize school calendar to 33 weeks of learning per year, ensuring greater coherence, inclusiveness, and alignment with national priorities such as *Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2)*, which emphasize a knowledge-based economy, responsible citizenship, and sustainable development.

Psychology at the upper secondary level aims to equip students with foundational knowledge, practical skills, and positive values needed to identify opportunities, solve real-life problems, and contribute meaningfully to their communities. The subject encourages students to think creatively, act ethically, and develop a sense of initiative, self-confidence, and social responsibility.

1.2. Teaching and learning Psychology

1.2.1. Rationale of teaching and learning Psychology

Psychology is central to understanding human behaviour, mental processes, and social interactions. Teaching Psychology helps students develop self-awareness, empathy, and intrapersonal and interpersonal understanding. It enables them to apply psychological concepts to promote personal growth, mental health, and harmonious coexistence in families, schools, and communities.

Through Psychology, students acquire skills in observation, analysis, and evidence-based reasoning, preparing them for further studies and various professions, counselling, social work, and human resource management. The subject fosters critical thinking, ethical decision-making, and resilience, the core competencies for holistic national development.

1.2.2. Psychology and society

Psychology enables students to understand how individuals and groups influence and are influenced by their social, cultural, and environmental contexts. Essentially, Psychology helps people in large part because it can explain why people act the way they do. With this kind of professional insight, a psychologist can help people improve their decision making, stress management and behavior based on understanding past behavior to better predict future behavior. All of this can help people have a more successful career, better relationships, more self-confidence and overall better communication. The subject of Psychology is paramount important in Rwanda given its history that climaxed in the 1994 Genocide against Tutsi impacting the people's mental health in general. This subject will produce more psychologists who will contribute to the development of the country and play a very vital role in raising awareness around mental health and an imminent need concerns the large gap between demand and supply in the domain of healing from psychological disorders.

1.2.3. Psychology and student

Psychology provides students with opportunities for self-exploration and growth, helping them develop self-awareness, resilience, and effective coping strategies. Psychology as a subject is a good choice for students who want to work with people and are interested in understanding human behavior and mental processes. Psychology gives students a sense of liberty to decide their own behavior. Awareness of one's attitude, values and personality are empowering as this will serve as a foundation to developing sense of self'. Helpful skills for Psychology majors include open-mindedness, critical thinking, problem solving and effective communication abilities. By learning how humans behave, students can apply some of the lessons to their own lives and potentially learn about themselves, too. Therefore, this subject helps people to handle stress, social dilemmas and high-pressure situations. This would also prompt students to take some precautionary measures to avoid harming themselves and/or others.

1.3. Competence

Competence is the ability to use an appropriate combination of knowledge, skills, attitudes, values and behavior to accomplish a particular task. That is the ability to apply learning with confidence in a range of situations. Basic competencies are addressed as broad subject competences and key competences embodied in the curriculum on year-on-year objectives and in clearly defined unit-specific learning competencies. Both generic competences and basic competences must be emphasized and consistently reflected in the teaching and learning process.

Competence in Psychology reflects students' ability to integrate knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values to understand and respond effectively to human behaviour and psychological phenomena. Teaching should emphasize critical analysis, empathy, ethical reasoning, and scientific inquiry. By acquiring these competences, students are better equipped to handle emotional challenges, maintain healthy relationships, and make informed, ethical decisions that contribute to personal and social well-being.

1.3.1. Generic competences

Generic competences are cross-cutting abilities developed across all subjects. They equip students with essential lifelong learning skills and underpin all other competences in the curriculum.

- **Critical and problem-solving skills:** Students develop the ability to think broadly and objectively, evaluate their causes and consequences, and suggest peaceful and practical solutions that contribute to harmony and sustainable living in their communities.
- **Creativity and innovation:** The acquisition of such skills will help students to take the initiative and use imagination beyond the knowledge provided, to generate new ideas and construct new concepts.
- **Research:** This will help students acquire the ability to gather, analyze, and interpret information from a variety of sources, including observations, interviews, and case studies to inform decisions and develop evidence-based conclusions.

- **Communication in official languages:** Teachers, irrespective of their subject, will ensure proper use of the language of instruction to help students communicate clearly, confidently, and respectfully in both spoken and written forms, enabling them to express ideas, negotiate, and present information effectively for logical and coherent exchange.
- **Cooperation, interpersonal management and life skills:** This competence enables students to work effectively with others, respect diverse opinions, and show empathy in group activities. It fosters moral values, responsibility, and active participation in community-oriented tasks such as environmental protection, health promotion, and service. Students also build social skills that enhance teamwork, leadership, and adaptability in addressing life's challenges.
- **Lifelong learning:** Students cultivate curiosity, initiative, and adaptability by linking classroom knowledge to real-life experiences. This empowers them with the ability to update knowledge and skills independently, cope with evolving societal needs, and pursue personal growth and continuous development.

1.3.2. Psychology broad competences

At the end of upper secondary education, students should be able to demonstrate the following broad competences specific to Psychology:

1. Apply psychological theories and thoughts to provide solutions mitigating human development problems.
2. Analyse the interactions of physiological and psychological functions on behavioural processes of human beings within the physical and social environment
3. Educate parents and the community on the fundamentals of providing a proper home to foster child growth and development.
4. Interpret different personality traits and how they influence behavior, thought, motivation, and emotion in a human being
5. Use theories and principles of learning to deal with behavioral changes

6. Act as a role model in inculcating positive attitudes and challenging negative motives among individuals
7. Apply social Psychology theories in the social context of development
8. Engage collaboratively in conflict resolution based on individuals' differences, intra and intergroup relationships and problems
9. Apply appropriate approaches to prevent the occurrence and worsening of psychosocial issues

1.3.3. Psychology and developing competences

The national policy documents basing on national aspirations identify some "*basic competencies*" alongside the "*generic competencies*" that will develop higher order thinking skills, and which will help subject learning and application of what has been learnt in real life situation through understanding, appreciation and presentation of information during the learning process, the student develops not only deductive and inductive skills but also communication, critical thinking and problem-solving skills in trying to make inferences and conclusions. Develop ability to discern and grasp attitudes, values feelings and ideas illustrated in scientific works not only analytically but also innovation, creativity and research. Group work and cooperative learning of Psychology promote interpersonal relations and teamwork. Learning Psychology prepares responsible citizens who are informed, sensitive, responsible citizen with the ability to critique and appreciate the methods used in the prevention and management of psychosocial issues and improvement of wellbeing at large.

2. Pedagogical approach

The pedagogical approach in Psychology under the CBC emphasizes student-centered, participatory, and inclusive methods that develop knowledge, skills, values, and competences for responsible citizenship. Teaching is interactive and active, engaging students through debates, discussions, role-plays, storytelling, field visits, projects, research, essay writing, case studies, reflective activities and personal growth. These approaches ensure that learning is enjoyable, personalized, and connected to real-life situations, while also fostering critical thinking, moral reasoning, and problem-solving.

2.1. Role of the teacher

The teaching and learning of Psychology at upper secondary school level must reflect the CBC principles, which promote student-centred, participatory, and practical methods. The main goal is to guide students acquire and apply Psychology knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes that prepare them to become innovative, responsible, and productive citizens.

Teachers should therefore move beyond traditional lecturing to interactive strategies that encourage inquiry, creativity, problem-solving, and collaboration. Learning must link theory with practice, making classroom experiences relevant to the student's environment and connect psychological concepts to daily life.

2.2. Role of the student

Students are active participants and co-creators of knowledge. They engage in inquiry, debates, problem-solving, and group collaboration while drawing connections between personal experiences, social realities, and religious teachings. Through these activities, students develop critical thinking, communication, respect for diversity, moral responsibility, and the ability to apply psychological insights to improve their well-being and relationships.

2.3. Inclusive and Special Needs Education (ISNE)

In line with Rwanda's inclusive education policy, all students regardless of ability have the right to access quality education. Teachers adapt teaching methods, materials, and assessment strategies to meet diverse needs, including those of students with disabilities. Differentiated instruction, assistive technologies, peer support, and individualized approaches are used to ensure equitable participation and achievement of learning outcomes. This inclusive approach recognizes students' varied paces, experiences, and abilities, creating an environment where every student can thrive.

3. Assessment approach

Assessment in the CBC is an essential part of the teaching and learning process, designed to evaluate students' progress in knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes while supporting continuous growth. It emphasizes real-life application and problem-solving, enabling students to demonstrate their competences in authentic contexts. Assessment involves systematically gathering and interpreting evidence to measure performance against established standards, providing constructive feedback to guide both teaching and learning.

Assessment should focus on students' ability to demonstrate creativity, innovation, problem-solving, ethical behaviour, and teamwork. It encourages reflection, continuous improvement, and the development of responsible entrepreneurial mindsets. It should therefore be comprehensive, covering both formative (continuous) and summative (end-of-term or national) evaluations. It should be transparent, fair, inclusive, and competence aligned.

3.1. Levels of assessment in Advanced Level across terms and national examinations

To provide a comprehensive picture of student achievement and development, assessment is conducted at multiple levels:

- i) **Diagnostic:** Conducted before instruction to identify students' prior knowledge and skills; administered at the beginning of a unit or lesson to guide teaching.
- ii) **Formative / Continuous:** Carried out during the learning process to track progress and provide feedback; implemented continuously through quizzes, projects, class activities, and teacher observations.
- iii) **Summative assessment:**
 - **End Term I:** Administered after instruction to evaluate students' achievement of Term I content; conducted at the end of the first term as a school-based assessment.
 - **End Term II:** District-coordinated assessment designed to measure achievement of Term II content; developed by schools and quality-checked at district level.

- **End Term III:** National assessment to evaluate mastery of the entire year's content; prepared, set, and moderated by NESA at the end of the third term.
- **National Examinations:** High-stakes assessments for certification, selection, and accountability; administered nationally at the end of key education cycles (P6, S3, S6) under NESA's authority. This examination integrates objective questions, structured responses, and applied tasks aligned with CBC principles to holistically measure student achievement.

In Advanced Level, all students will take 11 subjects in total: 7 core subjects and 4 compulsory subjects. Compulsory subjects include ICT, Entrepreneurship, General and Religious Studies, and Physical Education and Sport, which are mandatory for all students across all pathways.

All subjects will be assessed at the national level, except for Physical Education and Sport, General and Religious Studies, ICT, and Entrepreneurship, which will be assessed at the school level only.

Average scores from school, District, and comprehensive summative assessments will be weighted and included in the final national examination grading, initially contributing 10%, with the percentage gradually increasing as teachers gain experience and confidence in assessment practices.

3.2. Record keeping

Accurate record keeping is essential for monitoring student progress and informing instructional decisions. Teachers use tools such as portfolios, checklists, and report books to collect evidence of learning. Portfolios include samples of students' work, test results, projects, and self-reflections, serving as both a record of achievement and a diagnostic tool for guiding remedial action. These records provide data for feedback to students, teachers, and parents, and contribute to final evaluations.

3.3. Item writing in summative assessment

Summative assessment items must be valid, fair, reliable, and aligned with CBC principles. They should test a range of competencies, including knowledge recall, application, analysis, and values integration, while reflecting real-life contexts. Item writers follow a structured process that involves:

- Identify topic areas to be tested from the subject syllabus.
- Outline subject matter content to be considered as the basis for the test.
- Identify learning outcomes to be measured by the test.
- Preparing a test blueprint or table of specifications.
- Using verbs that require higher-order thinking beyond memorization.
- Applying transparent and consistent marking schemes.
- Greater weight is given to higher-order cognitive skills as stated in the syllabus.

3.4. Structure and format of national examinations

At the end of upper secondary education, students sit for a national examination that evaluates the psychological competences developed throughout the course. A single integrated paper is administered, covering the key components of the syllabus. The examination consists of diverse item types including objective questions, structured responses, and applied tasks designed to holistically assess students' mastery of subject content, analytical skills, and the broader CBC competences. An examination of three (3) hours will be set and will consist of three sections, "A", "B" and "C".

Section A

All questions in section “A” will be compulsory and will require clear and brief answers. This section will carry 40 marks. The questions will be set to give candidates the opportunity to read extensively and express informed, critical thinking, innovative and creative and relevant responses relating to the overall student’s level of knowledge, understanding and comprehension of the syllabus topics and objectives.

Section B

This section will be general in nature and require candidates to draw on their knowledge from across the syllabus while demonstrating an ability to explain, discuss, examine, apply, analyse, synthesize, evaluate, describe and show support for significant issues related to psychological activities. This section will carry 30 marks and students will answer a given number of questions as instructed. The ability to convey a sustained and well thought out argument will be credited.

Section C

This section will be specific in nature and require candidates to draw on their knowledge from across the syllabus while demonstrating an ability to design, invent, produce, devise, develop, propose, generate, reconstruct, plan, and apply significant issues related to psychological activities. This section will carry 30 marks and students will answer the number of questions given as instructed.

3.5. Reporting to parents

Regular communication with parents is an essential component of the CBC. This is achieved through progress reports, parent–teacher meetings, and school community activities. Since the CBC emphasizes a wide range of learning outcomes: knowledge, skills, attitudes, and competences, a single mark is insufficient to capture student progress. Effective reporting should highlight areas where students are excelling as well as those requiring improvement. Using descriptive feedback or simple rating scales (e.g., meeting expectations very well, meeting expectations, not meeting expectations) across knowledge, subject-specific skills, and competences provides a

clearer and more comprehensive picture than numerical grades alone. This approach fosters meaningful parental involvement and supports students' continued growth.

4. Resources

The effective implementation of this syllabus requires the provision and utilization of appropriate resources. These resources include both teaching and learning materials and qualified human personnel, without which the delivery of the syllabus would be ineffective. Teachers are encouraged to utilize both locally available and digital resources to create rich, relevant, and engaging learning experiences that promote creativity, problem-solving, and entrepreneurial thinking.

4.1. Materials needed for implementation of this syllabus

A variety of materials are essential to facilitate the effective teaching and learning of Psychology. These resources provide students with practical experiences, stimulate reflection, and foster the development of competences in understanding human behaviour, emotions, and mental processes. They include:

- **Textbooks and reference materials:** Updated Psychology textbooks, teacher's guides, student's books, dictionaries, and relevant reference materials that support both theoretical and practical learning. These should include examples and case studies contextualized to Rwanda's cultural and social realities.
- **Teaching and learning aids:** Visual and audio-visual resources such as charts, posters, infographics, models of the brain and sensory organs, diagrams, projectors, and educational videos. Digital tools such as e-books, online platforms, and multimedia applications should be used to illustrate key psychological concepts such as motivation, emotion, perception, and learning and to enhance students' understanding through interactive experiences.
- **Library and resource centre materials:** Access to a well-stocked library with Psychology journals, case studies, biographies of psychologists, and research reports. These materials encourage students to engage in further reading, independent research, and evidence-based inquiry.

- **Psychology simulation and practical resources:** Observation checklists, behavioural recording sheets, and simulation exercises such as mock counselling sessions, role plays, and group experiments. These enable students to apply psychological theories to real-life situations, enhancing problem-solving and communication skills.
- **Field visit resources:** Materials to support fieldwork and educational visits, such as observation journals, notebooks, questionnaires, and logistical support. Visits to counselling centres, ECD centres, hospitals, rehabilitation institutions, or schools provide students with experiential learning about mental health services and human behaviour in different settings.
- **Community, cultural resources and memorial sites of genocide against Tutsi in 1994:** Collaboration with local leaders, religious and cultural institutions, museums, memorial sites against Tutsi in 1994, and community groups to promote understanding of social values, resilience, trauma healing, and post-genocide against Tutsi mental health. These interactions help students relate psychological concepts to Rwanda's cultural and historical context.
- **Assessment tools:** Rubrics, checklists, student portfolios, self-assessment forms, and test materials that support continuous and summative assessment in line with the CBC. These tools help teachers evaluate students' progress in acquiring psychological knowledge, attitudes, and practical competences.

All materials and resources should be **inclusive and accessible**, ensuring that students with special educational needs can participate fully through adapted materials, assistive technologies, and flexible approaches.

4.2. Human resources

The successful implementation of this syllabus relies heavily on qualified, competent, and motivated human resources. The following are key personnel required for effective implementation:

- **Teachers:** Professional and well-trained Psychology teachers with both subject expertise and strong pedagogical skills in student-centred, participatory, and inclusive approaches. Teachers should model empathy, integrity, respect, and emotional stability, while facilitating discussions, projects, and activities that develop critical thinking, self-awareness, and interpersonal skills. They should also apply diverse assessment strategies to measure students' understanding, attitudes, and application of psychological concepts.

- **Community resource persons:** Mental health professionals, counsellors, social workers, psychologists, and educators who can share real-life experiences and insights. They may participate as guest speakers, mentors, or facilitators during school visits, workshops, and field activities, helping students connect psychological theories with real-life practice and community well-being.
- **Parents and guardians:** Partners in the educational process who provide emotional and moral support, monitor students' academic and behavioural progress, and collaborate with teachers to reinforce values such as empathy, responsibility, respect, and resilience at home. Their involvement helps strengthen students' emotional well-being and overall psychological development.
- **Local authorities and partners:** Support schools by linking them with mental health services, youth empowerment programs, and community-based initiatives that provide practical learning opportunities. They play a key role in promoting psychosocial well-being, awareness of mental health, and creating environments that foster personal

Effective collaboration among stakeholders creates an enabling learning environment that equips students with Psychology knowledge, values, and practical competences needed for responsible citizenship, ethical behaviour, and meaningful contribution to national development.

4.3. Skills required for the teacher of Psychology

Effective implementation of this syllabus requires teachers with strong subject knowledge, pedagogical competence, and interpersonal skills. As facilitators and role models, teachers of Psychology guide students to develop critical thinking, empathy, ethical awareness, and an understanding of human behaviour that can be applied in real-life contexts. To achieve these goals, teachers should demonstrate the following key skills:

4.3.1. Subject matter expertise

- Strong mastery of Psychology concepts such as learning, motivation, perception, personality, development, emotion, and mental health.

- Ability to link psychological theories and principles with real-life examples and national priorities such as Rwanda's Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2).
- Skill in relating Psychology to other disciplines such as Biology, History, Languages, General and Religious Studies, to enhance interdisciplinary learning.
- Awareness of contemporary issues and trends in Psychology, including the use of technology in learning, mental health promotion, and social well-being.

4.3.2. Pedagogical and instructional skills

- Ability to design and implement student-centred, participatory, and inclusive teaching methods that encourage observation, experimentation, reflection, and critical analysis.
- Use of diverse teaching methods such as role plays, case studies, guided discovery, and fieldwork to make psychological concepts practical and engaging.
- Creativity and innovation in developing and applying diverse teaching resources, including ICT tools, realia, and community-based materials.
- Ability to adjust instruction to students' levels, ensuring inclusivity and engagement for all.
- Skill in managing classroom dynamics sensitively, respecting student diversity, and fostering a supportive and emotionally safe learning environment.

4.3.3. Assessment skills

- Proficiency in designing and using both formative and summative assessments aligned with CBC competencies.
- Effective use of rubrics, portfolios, checklists, reflection journals, and peer assessments to evaluate students' understanding and growth in psychological competences.

- Skill in developing valid, reliable, and fair assessment items that measure critical thinking, self-reflection, and application of psychological knowledge.
- Ability to analyze assessment outcomes to provide targeted support, guidance, and feedback for students' academic and emotional development.

4.3.4. Classroom management and facilitation

- Ability to establish a respectful, safe, and inclusive learning environment that promotes tolerance and values diversity.
- Proficiency in managing discussions on sensitive psychological topics with discretion, empathy, and professionalism.
- Competence in guiding cooperative learning, group investigations, and role plays that develop students' analytical and interpersonal skills.
- Consistent modelling of positive behaviour, emotional control, respect, and integrity as examples for students.

4.3.5. Communication and Interpersonal skills

- Excellent oral and written communication to clarify abstract psychological concepts, stimulate reflection, and facilitate discussion.
- Active listening, empathy, and sensitivity to students' emotional needs and personal differences.
- Collaboration with colleagues, parents, school leaders, and community professionals (e.g., counsellors, psychologists) to support students' holistic well-being.
- Ability to motivate and inspire students through encouragement and positive reinforcement.

4.3.6. Guidance and counselling skills

- Ability to provide psychological support, moral guidance, and emotional counselling to students, fostering confidence, resilience, and self-regulation.
- Demonstrating passion, patience, impartiality, and genuine care in dealing with students' individual differences and challenges.
- Supporting students in exploring career aspirations, personal development, and positive mental health practices.

4.3.7. Professional and ethical competence

- Upholding high ethical standards, integrity, impartiality in all teaching and assessment practices, and ethical conduct, serving as a role model for students.
- Capacity to balance academic instruction with the cultivation of values and responsible citizenship.
- Demonstrating commitment to continuous professional development (CPD) through reflective practice, practice, peer collaboration, and engagement with emerging research in Psychology.
- Promoting national values, peacebuilding, and responsible citizenship in alignment with Rwanda's education philosophy.

4.3.8. Research and innovation skills

- Engagement in action research and reflective practice to continuously improve teaching and learning of Psychology.
- Adaptation of innovative approaches and new technologies to enhance student participation.
- Encouraging students to apply psychological research methods in projects and community-based activities that promote well-being and problem-solving.

- Connecting global psychological insights to Rwanda’s socio-cultural context to promote relevance and applied learning.

Teachers who possess these competences will not only deliver Psychology effectively but will also serve as mentors and role models, inspiring students to become empathetic, ethical, and responsible citizens who contribute positively to personal and national development.

5. Syllabus Units

5.1. Presentation of the structure of the syllabus

The Psychology syllabus is designed as a single, integrated syllabus implemented uniformly across all grades. Its structure follows a logical progression that ensures clarity, consistency, and alignment with the CBC approach. At each grade level, the syllabus is organized into topic areas, which are further broken down into sub-topic areas. Each sub-topic area is composed of units, and every unit is characterized by the following features:

- 1. Alignment with lessons:** Each unit corresponds to a specified number of lessons, ensuring effective time allocation and instructional planning.
- 2. Key Unit Competence:** Every unit is built around a *Key Unit Competence* that guides all teaching and learning activities. This competence represents the overall learning goal to be achieved by both teacher and students.
- 3. Learning objectives:** Each key unit competence is translated into specific learning objectives, categorized as follows:
 - **Type I (Knowledge and Understanding):** Focused on foundational knowledge and comprehension, often referred to as *Lower Order Thinking Skills (LOTS)*.
 - **Type II and Type III (Skills, Attitudes, and Values):** Aimed at developing practical skills, critical thinking, ethical values, and positive attitudes. These objectives, known as *Higher Order Thinking Skills (HOTS)*, form the core focus of the adapted Competence-Based Curriculum.

- 4 *Content Specification:* Each unit outlines the scope of content to be taught and learned, ensuring that teachers and students work within the boundaries set by the stated learning objectives. Each unit suggests a non-exhaustive list of learning activities that are expected to engage, as much as possible, students in an interactive learning process (student-centered and participatory approaches). Finally, each unit is linked to other subjects, its assessment criteria, and the materials (or Resources) that are expected to be used in teaching and learning process.

The Psychology syllabus for languages Pathways has in total 8 main topic areas, 15 subtopic areas, 23 units and 297 periods. These units are distributed as follows:

- **Senior four:** 6 units with 99 periods
- **Senior five:** 8 units with 99 periods
- **Senior six:** 9 units with 99 periods

SENIOR FOUR

5.2. Psychology Syllabus of Senior Four for Languages Pathway

General competences of the subject at the end of Senior Four

At the end of Senior Four, each student should be able to:

- Demonstrate understanding of psychological ideas and how Psychology applies to everyday life.
- Justify how key schools of Psychology support different branches of psychology, and apply those branches to every day's life
- Analyze the physical, cognitive, emotional, and social aspects of human development across the lifespan.
- Demonstrate an understanding of theories of human development in real-life
- Analyze human developmental milestones across the lifespan based on physical, cognitive, language and socio-emotional skills.
- Examine the factors of human development.
- Apply knowledge and skills acquired throughout the year to analyse how environmental factors influence adolescent development and suggest practical solutions.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: General psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to psychology	
Unit 1: Introduction to Psychology				Nº of Periods: 18
Key unit competence: Demonstrate understanding of key psychological concepts, major figures, and the role of Psychology in life				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Define key concepts of psychology – Describe briefly the history of psychology – Explain why Psychology is considered as a science. – Describe the contributions of major figures in Psychology	– Construct own meaning of Psychology. – Apply basic psychological concepts to explain everyday human behavior. – Use Psychology in our daily life. – Defend the importance of Psychology in daily life	– Appreciate the relevance of Psychology in understanding themselves and others. – Defend the relevance of Psychology in our daily life. – Develop curiosity and an open mind toward scientific study of behavior and mental processes.	– Key concepts of Psychology (<i>Psychology, mind, behaviour, mental processes, emotion, motivation, memory, perception and sensation</i>) – Brief history of psychology – Scope of psychology – Psychology as a science	– In pairs, students make a concept map of their understanding of the meaning of Psychology and its concepts – In small groups, students match key terms (behavior, mind, emotion, motivation, etc.) with their correct definitions. – Students, watching a short video about the origin of Psychology and in groups, create a timeline showing important milestones in the development of psychology.

- Explain the goals and importance of psychology			- Main figures in Psychology (<i>Wilhelm Wundt: the father of psychology; Aristotle, Socrates, Plato, Sigmund Freud, Marry Whitton, Jean Piaget</i>) - Goals and importance of Psychology	- In groups, students read handout explaining why Psychology is called a science and share understanding. - In groups, students discuss and present about the perspectives of the main figures in Psychology - Individually, students write essays about the contribution of Psychology to human daily life. - In groups, students discuss links between Psychology and languages learning and present findings in plenary session
Link to other subjects: Psychology Art and Humanities, History, Literature in English.				
Assessment criteria: Students accurately explain key psychological concepts, identify major figures in psychology, and illustrate the relevance of Psychology to everyday life with concrete examples.				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart, markers, flash cards, psychologist profiles, handouts describing concepts of psychology, internet, videos about the origin of Psychology				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: General psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Schools and branches of Psychology	
Unit 2: Schools and branches of Psychology				No of Periods: 15
Key unit competence: Justify how key schools of Psychology support different branches of psychology, and apply those branches to every day's life				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Values and Attitude		
– Explain different thoughts in schools of Psychology – Describe the key points of different schools of Psychology – Explain different branches of Psychology	– Compare and contrast different schools of Psychology based on their focus, methods, and assumptions. – Classify examples of human behavior according to the appropriate school or branch of psychology. – Make a reflection on others' work, ideas to sort out which is best for societal benefits.	– Appreciate the diversity of schools and branches of psychology. – Demonstrate confidence when sharing opinions on psychological perspectives. – Reflect critically on psychological theories to determine their value to society.	– Introduction to schools of Psychology: Structuralism, Functionalism, Psychoanalysis, – Introduction to schools of Psychology: Behaviorism, Humanistic. – Introduction to branches of Psychology: Developmental psychology, educational psychology, cognitive psychology	– In groups, students read handouts about schools of Psychology and share their findings – Students, in groups, watch videos about schools of Psychology and share their observations – Students take time to go through each branch of psychology, discuss its importance and share ideas during plenary sessions

– Summarize different thoughts found in schools of psychology – State the implications of schools and branches of Psychology in society	– Analyze real-life cases using psychological perspectives to explain human behavior and language learning.		– Introduction to branches of Psychology: social psychology, family psychology – Introduction to branches of Psychology: clinical psychology, forensic Psychology – Contribution of branches of Psychology to the understanding of human behaviour and language learning	– In pairs, students match branches of Psychology with their descriptions using flashcards – Individually, students list similarities and differences between schools and between branches. – In groups, students create maps linking each school/branch to its founder, main ideas, and focus. – Students write an essay about the contribution of branches of Psychology to language learning
Link to other subjects: History, Literature in English, Psychology Art and Humanities.				
Assessment criteria: Students can write an essay distinguishing branches of Psychology and how they contribute to the understanding of human behavior				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart, markers, handouts describing branches and schools of Psychology, videos, internet, flash cards				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Human development			Sub-Topic Area: Fundamentals of Human Development	
Unit 3: Introduction to human development				Nº of Periods: 18
Key unit competence: Analyze the physical, cognitive, emotional, and social aspects of human development across the lifespan.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Distinguish terms of developmental psychology – Outline human developmental domains – Describe the main domains and periods of human development. – Explain basic functions of the brain the role of brain development in influencing learning and behavior.	– Compare and contrast meanings of developmental Psychology terms – Relate periods of development with those said in Rwandan Culture – Classify developmental skills according to developmental domains	– Appreciate the importance of respecting individual differences in rates and patterns of human development. – Demonstrate positive attitudes toward supporting others' developmental needs at different stages of life	– Key concepts of human development (development, growth, maturation, life span, holistic, reflexes, stimulus, developmental milestones.) – Principles of human development – Human developmental domains	– Student, individually makes an illustration of terms related to developmental psychology – In small groups, students draw or design a chart showing periods of human development and describe the physical, cognitive, emotional, and social changes in each stage. – Students watch a video on child development and in pairs, classify the observed skills under an appropriate developmental domain and do presentation in class.

– Break down the roles played by the limbic and frontal regions of the brain during emotion processing	– Interpret the interrelationships among developmental domains – Summarize periods of development based on described behaviors at a given period – Select some of the social effects resulting from a typical emotional processing – Describe systems that allow the brain to interact with the environment	– Value the role of healthy brain development and balanced growth in promoting overall well-being and lifelong learning	– Stages of human development – Brain Development	– In groups, students confer and document implications of different developmental principles in their books; they come up with their views and present them in plenary session. – Students work in pairs to link skills to the corresponding developmental domains – In groups, students conduct discussions on interconnectedness of brain development with human developmental domains. – Students watch video about brain development and individual development, draw a brain map with its architecture.
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Link to other subjects: Psychology for Art and Humanities, Biology.

Assessment criteria: Students can describe human development process by connecting them to their own development. They can also describe how the brain functioning impact on human behavior in relation to the environmental settings.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart, markers, flash cards, handouts with information about key terms of developmental psychology, internet

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Human development			Sub-Topic Area: Fundamentals of human development	
Unit 4: Theories of human development				Nº of Periods: 12
Key unit competence: Demonstrate an understanding of theories of human development in real-life				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Explain the meaning of concepts necessary to understand the theories of human growth and development. – Describe theories of human development with their implications to real life	– Compare and contrast theories of human development – Create scenarios to explain theories of human development – Sketch stages and main features of the three theories using charts, diagrams, or presentations	– Display confidence in commenting about the merits of theories of human development – Develop positive attitude towards individual's emotions, social, and cognitive differences as explained by the various theories.	– Key concepts of human development theories (theory, stage, erogenous zone, identity formation, assimilation, cognitive, psychosexual, psychosocial) – Psychosexual theory (Sigmund Freud)	– In pairs, students match key concepts to their meanings – Students, in groups, read information about different theorists who contributed to human development and present the findings. – Students design a comparative chart highlighting the stages, main focus, and contributions of Freud, Erikson, and Piaget's theories – Students explain how different theorists' ideas are linked to language learning by writing short case studies.

– Describe the main ideas and stages of Freud's, Erikson's, and Piaget's theories of human development. – Differentiate among psychosexual, psychosocial, and cognitive development theories in terms of their focus and contribution to understand human growth.		– Value the contribution of developmental theorists in improving education, parenting, and personal growth practices.	– Psychosocial development theory (Erick Erikson) – Cognitive development theory (Jean Piaget)	– Individually, students do research and gather more information about theorists they find most interesting and present findings to the whole class. – In groups, students do compare debate about the most helpful idea from the theorists they studied with justification. – Individually, students write a brief composition reflecting on his or her own development by considering experiences that relate to Erikson's psychosocial stages or Piaget's cognitive stages
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Link to other subjects: Psychology for Art and Humanities, Biology.

Assessment criteria: Students describe different stages of human development according to specific theorists by giving typical examples from real life

Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart, markers, handouts describing Developmental theories and charts with Developmental theories, internet

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Human development			Sub-Topic Area: Milestones and factors of human development	
Unit 5: Introduction to developmental milestones				Nº of Periods: 27
Key unit competence: Analyze human developmental milestones across the lifespan based on physical, cognitive, language and socio-emotional skills.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Explain the key concepts related to developmental milestones – Describe what happens during prenatal. – Identify the risk factors for women and infants during pregnancy and delivery	– Classify milestones for each period of development – Arrange prenatal developmental milestones – Create scenarios sequencing human developmental milestones from birth to adulthood.	– Appreciate the role of parents in supporting their child's development – Value the importance of prenatal care to support development – Appreciate that every stage of human development has positive and critical aspects.	– Key concepts related to Developmental milestones (milestones, conception, prenatal, childhood adolescence, adult, old age) – Prenatal developmental milestones – Risk factors for women and infants during pregnancy and delivery	– In pairs, students match concepts to their meanings – Individually, students read handout about human developmental milestones and make charts of the developmental milestones' key concepts. – Students watch video about developmental milestones and in small groups present summarized findings. – Students in think-pair-share, brainstorm ways to support development of skills across all developmental domains

- Explain the developmental milestones for each stage of development	- Make a linkage supporting activities to the developmental milestones for each domain of development. - Develop a key message to pregnant ladies		- Key message and recommended practices during 1000 Days - Developmental milestones during childhood - Developmental milestones during adolescence - Developmental milestones during adulthood	- In small groups, students sort skills by developmental domain and sequence and present them to others. - Students, in pairs, read about risk factors during pregnancy and share their findings. - Students visit the nearest homebased ECD, check if children are meeting the appropriate age level milestones, write their findings in essay form
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Link to other subjects: Biology, Psychology for Art and Humanities.

Assessment criteria: Students can examine human development milestones and describe ways of promoting developmental abilities in different developmental domains at each stage.

Teaching and learning materials: Audio-visual materials, handouts, pictures, printed case studies, developmental milestones charts, internet

Subject: Psychology		Senior Four		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Human development			Sub-Topic Area: Factors of human development	
Unit 6: Factors of human development				Nº of Periods: 9
Key unit competence: Examine the factors of human development				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Define key terms related to human development such as nature, nurture, heredity, genes, and DNA. – Identify the main factors influencing human development – Describe how human development is influenced by heredity and environment	– Compare and contrast biological and environmental factors which influence human development – Interpret real-life cases or scenarios showing the interaction between biological and environmental factors. – Debate on the effect of nature and nurture on human development	– Demonstrates appreciation for diversity in human development – Respect human beings regardless of their differences – Value the role of a responsive community in supporting human development	– Key terms related to factors of human development (nature, heredity, environment, nurture, genes, DNA) – Biological factors (nature / heredity) – Environmental factors (nurture / experiential)	– In pairs, students match key terms (nature, nurture, heredity, genes, environment, DNA) with their correct definitions. – Individually, students write down their own characteristics that make them unique and try to explain how they came to possess those characteristics (skill, ability, interest, trait, ...) – Students share in pairs what they see as the factors that had the greatest impact on their development then share to the plenary.

– Explain how heredity and environmental work together to shape a human being – Explain the negative impact of drug abuse on physical, psychological, and social development	– Suggests possible solutions to improve human development conditions	– Develop a commitment to avoiding drug use and promoting drug-free lifestyles. – Appreciate the role of family and society in supporting holistic human development.	– Influence of socialising agents on human development – Impact of drug abuse on human development	– In groups, students read case studies of different children and analyze heredity reasons and environmental reasons of their differences – In pairs, students create a two-column chart comparing examples of biological vs. environmental influences in real life. – In groups, students debate about nature vs nurture – Students share in pairs positive ways to resist peer pressure related to drug use.
Link to other subjects: Biology, Psychology for Art and Humanities, General and Religious Studies.				
Assessment criteria: Students can write essay that evaluate how nature and nurture interact together to shape human behavior				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip chart, markers, handouts describing genetical and environmental factors, internet				

SENIOR FIVE

5.3. Psychology Syllabus of Senior Five for Languages Pathway

Key competences at the end of Senior Five

At the end of Senior Five for Languages Pathway, each student should be able to:

- Demonstrate an understanding of how both nature and nurture play a role in shaping personality
- Assess different views of psychologists related to personality
- Analyze personality disorders and interpret strategies of intervention
- Examine the role of initiative, curiosity and creativity in one's learning.
- Provide opinions on the underlying theories of learning
- Compare and contrast types of behavioral learning
- Analyze the nature and stages of memory processing and how intelligence impacts human behavior
- Demonstrate proper coping with and management of emotions.
- Apply knowledge and skills acquired throughout the year to analyse how the school environment influences learning and suggest practical solutions.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Five		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Personality			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to personality	
Unit 1: Introduction to personality				Nº of Periods: 12
Key unit competence: Demonstrate an understanding of personality and how both nature and nurture play a role in shaping personality				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Define key concepts related to personality. – Describe individuals' behaviour based on different traits. – Classify factors that make people different based on nature and nurture. – Explain how environment and family are factors to human personality development	– Link the individuals' lifestyle to behaviour in real life – Use understanding of traits to interact effectively and solve conflicts. – Illustrate the concept of personality using real-life examples or case studies.	– Value the importance of developing positive personality traits such as honesty, empathy, and self-confidence – Appreciate the role of biological and environmental factors in shaping our personality.	– Key concepts of personality (personality, character, temperaments, traits, nature, nurture, behaviour,) – Personality traits (Big Five Traits: Openness to experience; Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness and Neuroticism.)	– Students read handout of personality concepts in pairs and present their summarized findings written on flashcards. – In groups, students discuss personality traits and present their findings to classmates. – In groups, students describe the Big Five personality traits using examples of famous people or fictional characters. – Students discuss in pairs how both nature (heredity) and nurture (environment) influence the development of personality.

– Identify major personality traits such as openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, and neuroticism. – Explain how different personality traits affect language learning performance	– Judge factors influencing personality	– Avoid judgment of others based on background or upbringing. – Recognize the influence of personality traits on language learning. – Commit to applying self-discipline and emotional control in interactions with peers and teachers.	– Factors influencing personality (nature vs nurture) – Personality traits and language learning	– Individually, students draw a timeline of their life, mark key events and identify which traits may have come from nature and which from nurture. – In groups, students conduct debate about factors which influence personality development. – In groups, students role-play how different personality types (e.g., extrovert vs. introvert) behave in a group discussion. – Students work in small groups to explain how personality traits can influence language learning outcomes (motivation, confidence, participation). – Individually, students write a short paragraph describing their own personality and how it affects their achievements.
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Link to other subjects: Biology, Psychology for Art and Humanities.

Assessment criteria: Students describe clearly the interactions between nature and nurture factors together with personality traits to shape human behaviour

Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and videos about personality development, internet

Subject: Psychology		Senior Five		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Personality			Sub-Topic Area: Theories of personality	
Unit 2: Theories of personality				Nº of Periods: 12
Key unit competence: Assess different views of psychologists related to personality				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Describe the key ideas and assumptions of the psychoanalytic theory (Sigmund Freud). – Explain the main principles of humanistic theory (Abraham Maslow). – Identify the core components of the social cognitive theory (Bandura)	– Compare and contrast different theories in terms of focus, approach, and application – Compare personal experiences or observed behaviors using different personality theories	– Appreciate the complexity and diversity of human personality – Show respect and empathy toward individual differences in behavior and personality – Value different thoughts and views as cited in theories of personality	Theories of personality: – Psychoanalytic theory of personality (Sigmund Freud). – Humanistic theory of personality (Maslow) – Social cognitive theory (Bandura)	– In groups, students read short texts or handouts on each theory and summarize key concepts in their own words – Individually, students match theorists with their corresponding personality theories and key terms. – In pairs, students create a visual map linking theorists, key concepts, and applications. – In groups, students analyze real-life cases to identify which personality theory explains the person's behavior

	- Critically evaluate the strengths and limitations of each personality theory - Apply concepts from personality theories to real-life situations or case studies	- Value the application of personality theories in improving interpersonal relationships - Demonstrate positive attitudes by collaborating effectively in diverse groups, promoting tolerance, respect, and teamwork.		- In groups, students act out behaviors of characters based on different personality theories and others guess which theory represents - In groups, students discuss how personality differences affect (positively or negatively) teamwork and social interactions - In pairs, students suggest ways personality theory can help resolve conflicts or improve teamwork in community settings. - In groups, students debate which theory best explains human motivation and personality development
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Art and Humanities

Assessment criteria: Students critically explain the theories of personality by demonstrating an understanding of their similarities, differences, and relevance to human behavior.

Teaching and learning materials: Books, Handouts about different theories of personality, journals photos, audio-visual material, flip chart, flashcards, markers

Subject: Psychology		Senior Five		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Personality			Sub-Topic Area: Personality disorders	
Unit 3: Personality disorders				Nº of Periods: 9
Key unit competence: Analyze personality disorders in terms of meaning, classification, causes, impacts, and management to promote understanding and support intervention				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Clarify the meaning and definition of personality Disorders. – Describe the major classifications of personality disorders. – Explain the causes and risk factors contributing to personality disorders.	– Present information about personality disorders through presentations or posters or reports – Apply Knowledge and understanding of the meaning of Personality disorders in screening individuals with susceptible behaviors.	– Demonstrate empathy toward individuals living with personality disorders – Show a non-judgmental and ethical attitude when discussing or analyzing others' psychological conditions.	– Meaning of personality disorders – Classification of personality disorders – Causes and risk factors of personality disorders – Impact of personality disorders	– In pairs, students read short texts or handouts about different personality disorders and summarize the main points. – Individually, students match the names of specific disorders with their descriptions or symptoms. – In small groups, students create a diagram showing how causes, impacts, and treatments of personality disorders are connected. – In groups, students act out a scenario showing how a person with a personality disorder might be supported by family

– Describe the impact of personality disorders on individuals, families, and society. – Identify different treatment and management approaches for personality disorders.	– Develop a diagram demonstrating personality disorders, their causes, their risk factors and their specific management and treatment approaches. – Evaluate the effectiveness of different treatment and management strategies	– Appreciate the importance of early diagnosis and treatment of personality disorders	– Treatment and management approaches of personality disorders	– Individually, students write a short reflection on how people with personality disorders should be treated in society. – In groups, students design slogans to promote understanding and reduce stigma related to personality disorders
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Art and Humanities.

Assessment criteria: Students can describe cause and impacts of personality disorders and explain different treatment and management approaches to support people with personality disorders.

Teaching and learning materials: Books, Handouts about different theories of personality, journals photos, audio-visual material, flip chart, flashcards, markers.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Five		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Personality		Sub-topic Area: Behavioral Learning		
Unit 4: Introduction to learning psychology				Nº of Periods:15
Key Unity Competence: Examine the role of initiative, curiosity and creativity in one's learning.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning Activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Explain the meaning of learning psychology – Identify the main characteristics of learning – Identify stages and styles of learning – Describe the domains of learning. – Identify major factors that influence learning,	– Compare and contrast domains of learning – Construct a concept map showing key features of learning. – Generate original ideas or creative solutions in a learning context.	– Appreciate the importance of continuous learning – Demonstrate patience and persistence in progressing through learning stages – Adopt positive attitude toward acquiring new knowledge. – Recognize the importance of holistic development	– The meaning and characteristics of learning. – Stages of learning – Domains of learning – Factors influencing learning – Learning styles and individual differences – Initiative, curiosity and creativity	– In groups, students brainstorm and present their understanding about learning and main characteristics. – In groups, students create a concept map showing characteristics of learning – Individually, students read handouts about domains of learning and in plenary, share their understanding – In pairs, students identify examples of learning experiences in daily life by relating them to cognitive, affective, and psychomotor domains.

– Differentiate between internal and external factors influencing learning – Explain the role of -Initiative, curiosity and creativity in learning	– Collaborate effectively to produce creative outputs that show understanding of learning processes. – Analyze examples from daily life where learning principles are evident.	– Appreciate the individual and environmental factors in learning and Responsibility for creating a conducive learning environment.	– Application of learning Psychology in real life	– In groups, students create a poster summarizing key factors influencing learning and present it to the class. – Individually, students write a short paragraph describing something new they recently learned in one of the languages (e.g., a grammar rule, a new word, or pronunciation) and explain how they learned it. – On roundtable, students discuss the contribution of initiative, curiosity and creativity to learning – Individually, students write a short essay on how understanding learning Psychology can improve personal study habits.
Link to other subjects: Languages subjects, Biology, Psychology for Art and Humanities.				
Assessment criteria: Students can analyze how initiative, curiosity, and creativity shape effective learning.				
Teaching and Learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, journals, handouts, internet, etc.				

SUBJECT: PSYCHOLOGY		SENIOR 5		PATHWAY: LANGUAGES
Topic Area: Learning psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Behavioral learning	
Unit 5: Theories of learning				Nº of Periods: 18
Key unit competence: <i>Provide opinions on the underlying theories of learning</i>				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Define key terms related to theories of learning – Describe the main ideas and principles of behaviorism, cognitivism, social learning, and connectivism – State the implications of different theories of learning in individual's daily life	– Compare and contrast theories of learning – Create scenarios which reflect theories of learning in daily life situation – Create visual tool to represent relationships among learning theories	– Appreciate the importance of understanding learning theories for effective personal development. – Demonstrate confidence in judging the merits of conflicting theories – Respect classmates' opinions and experiences related to different learning styles	– Key terms related to theories of learning (behaviourism, connectivism, cognitive, schemata, stimulus, response) – Behaviorism learning theory – Cognitive learning theory – Social learning theory	– In groups, students share ideas about key terms and concepts related to learning theories and present findings in plenary sessions. – In pairs, students, match each theorist with their learning theory and main concept (e.g., Skinner (reinforcement)). – Students watch videos about different learning theories and in groups, summarize what they have seen – In groups, students create a concept-maps to represent relationships among learning theories

– Identify similarities and differences among the four learning theories.	– Communicate and justify their perspectives on which learning theory best supports language learning		– Connectivism learning theory	– In pairs, create a table comparing the four learning theories (main ideas, key theorists, – Individually, students explain how different theorists' ideas link to individuals' daily life situations by writing short case studies reflecting how people behave in different contexts – In groups, students debate on which is the most helpful idea from the theorists they studied, with justification
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Link to other subjects: *Psychology for Art and Humanities, Languages subjects.*

Assessment criteria: *Students describe the main learning theories and provides clear opinions supported by relevant examples.*

Teaching and learning materials: *Handouts and videos about different learning theories, fact sheets about different theorists, internet, flip charts, flash cards, and wall charts with graphics to represent learning theories*

SUBJECT: PSYCHOLOGY			SENIOR 5		PATHWAY: LANGUAGES
Topic Area: Learning Psychology				Sub-Topic Area: Behavioral learning	
Unit 6: Types of behavioral learning					Nº of Periods: 12
Key unit competence: <i>Compare and contrast types of behavioral learning</i>					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
– Define behavioral learning and explain its basic principles. – Identify the main types of behavioral learning – Describe the key points of different types of behavioral learning – Explain how behavior is acquired and maintained through conditioning	– Compare and contrast types of learning – Create scenarios which reflect types of learning in daily life situation – Illustrate the process of classical or operant conditioning using real-life cases.	– Appreciate the role of environment and experience in shaping behavior – Show appreciation for the usefulness of behavioral learning in improving human and social behavior	– Understanding behavioural learning. – Classical conditioning – Operant Conditioning (positive reinforcement and positive punishment) – Strategies for using behavioural learning in different lifestyles.	– In groups, students brainstorm what the term “behavior” means and give examples of learned behaviors. – Students watch videos about behavioral learning experiments as carried out by researchers and in pairs, share what they observed – In groups, students read short scenarios showing reinforcement and punishment, then classify each as positive reinforcement or positive punishment. – In pairs, students make a chart to compare how different behavioral learning theorists view learning and then make a comparison.	

– Distinguish between positive reinforcement and positive punishment. – Identify real-life examples that illustrate each type of behaviorist learning. – State the implications of different types of learning in individual's daily life	– Design simple behavior modification plans based on behaviorist principles.	– Demonstrate open-mindedness toward applying behaviorist strategies in different life contexts – Develop a positive attitude toward self-discipline and personal behavior change.		– In pairs, students discuss real-life examples (in school, at home, or at work) where reinforcement or punishment influences behavior. – In groups, students create visual tool comparing classical and operant conditioning. – Individually, students write about what they learned from designing and observing behavior changes in themselves or others. – In groups, students debate on which is the most helpful idea from the theorists they studied, with justification
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Link to other subjects: *General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Art and Humanities.*

Assessment criteria: *Students accurately distinguish types of behavioral learning by explaining their main principles and providing relevant real-life examples.*

Teaching and learning materials: *Handouts and videos about different behavioral learning theories, fact sheets about different theorists, internet, flip charts, Flash cards, and wall charts with graphics to represent behavioral learning theories*

SUBJECT: PSYCHOLOGY		SENIOR 5		PATHWAY: LANGUAGES
Topic Area: Learning psychology		SUB TOPIC AREA: Memory and intelligence		
Unit 7: Memory and intelligence				Nº of Periods:12
Key Unity Competency: <i>Analyze the nature and stages of memory processing and how intelligence impacts human behavior</i>				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning Activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Define memory and intelligence – Identify different stages of processing memory. – Explain effective strategies that improve memory retention and recall – Explain the interference and trace decay theories of forgetting	– Illustrate the stages of memory – Assess different types of intelligence (such as linguistic, logical, spatial, interpersonal, etc.) – Evaluate the effectiveness of personal memory-enhancement techniques.	– Show interest in exploring how memory and intelligence affect learning. – Live and deal with all people respecting their individual differences in terms of intelligence capabilities.	– Understanding memory and intelligence – Levels/Stages of processing memory – Strategies for enhancing memory – Interference and trace decay theories of forgetting – Types of intelligence – Intellectual disability	– Through think –pair- share- students brainstorm the meaning of memory and intelligence – Students read a text explaining the importance of memory and intelligence, then summarize key ideas in pairs. – In groups, students read the handouts on memory processing and explain how information moves from short-term to long-term memory. – In pairs, students discuss in pairs how forgetting happens based on interference and trace decay theories. – In groups, students create a poster showing types of intelligences with real-life examples.

– Distinguish types of intelligence – Identify intellectually disabilities – Describe impact of intellectual disability to student's achievement. – Explain how memory and intelligence aid in learning vocabulary, grammar, and communication skills.	– Organize information into meaningful patterns or structures for better long-term retention. – Assess personal strengths and weaknesses in various cognitive abilities. – Link memory and intelligence in learning tasks (e.g., using memory strategies to enhance problem-solving).	– Refer to researches on intelligence to understand how people do the way they do. – Show sensitivity toward learners with intellectual disabilities.	– Roles of memory and intelligence in language learning	– Students watch a short video or presentation about inclusion and in groups, summarize key points. – Through think-pair-share technique, students suggest best practices needed to cater for people with profound intellectual Disability. – Students read case study about intellectual disability, and in groups, share understanding – Students in pairs perform a language memory game (e.g., word chain, vocabulary recall challenge); then, reflect on how memory and intelligence helped them succeed – Individually, students write a short reflection that describe the roles of memory and intelligence in language learning
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Link to other subjects: *Biology, Psychology for Art and Humanities.*

Assessment criteria: *Students can write an essay assessing how intelligence impacts human behavior and learning*

Teaching and Learning materials: *Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and videos about memories and Intelligence, internet, journals on memory and intelligence.*

SUBJECT: PSYCHOLOGY		SENIOR 5		PATHWAY: LANGUAGES	
Topic Area: Health Psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Emotional Management		
Unit 8: Emotions				Nº of Periods: 9	
Key unit competence: Demonstrate proper ways of coping with and managing emotions					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
– Define emotions and explain their role in human behavior. – Identify and classify different types of emotions – Describe major theories of emotions – Explain the relationship between stress, emotions, and wellbeing.	– Analyze effects of stress on the human body – Compare and contrast theories of emotions – Develop tips which may help individuals cope with and manage stress	– Value the importance of emotional management to enhance well-being – Appreciate the process to manage individuals' emotions – Demonstrate empathy and understanding toward others' emotions. – Show responsibility for managing one's own emotional health.	– Understanding emotions – Types of emotions – Theories of emotions – Stress management – Wellbeing	– Individually, students brainstorm their understanding on emotion and its effects on people well-being – In pairs, students match emotions (e.g., happiness, anger, fear) with corresponding facial expressions or situations. – In groups, students act out an emotion without speaking while others guess it. – In groups, students list as many emotions as they can and classify them into positive, negative, and neutral.	

– Describe strategies for maintaining emotional wellbeing. – Explain major emotional coping mechanisms and stress management – Identify elements that leads to a sense of well-being	– Use strategies to enhance personal wellbeing and emotional balance	– Develop a positive attitude toward applying stress management and wellbeing strategies. – Value emotional wellbeing as an essential component of overall health.	– Through think pair chair, students describe how they can cope with stress – In groups, students create a visual representation linking emotions, coping strategies and wellbeing outcomes. – Individually, students write an essay describing what leads to a sustained well-being they could do differently. – In pairs, students write a short paragraph about why managing emotions is important for mental health and relationships.
Link to other subjects: <i>General and Religious Studies, Biology, Physical Education and Sports, Psychology for Art and Humanities.</i>			
Assessment criteria: <i>Demonstrates the ability to recognize, express, and manage emotions effectively in self and others</i>			
Teaching and learning materials: <i>Books, handouts of types and theories of emotions, stress management, well-being, case studies, scenarios, videos, internet</i>			

SENIOR SIX

5.4. Psychology Syllabus of Senior Six for Languages Pathway

Key competences at the end of Senior Six

At the end of Senior Six for Languages Pathway, each student should be able to:

- Analyze how individual behavior is influenced by social contexts and interactions
- Judge different views of social psychologists about human behaviour formation and change.
- Assess group phenomenon and their effect on people's behavior
- Explore how culture influences behavior, communication, and interpretation of language across cultures.
- Analyze basics of psycholinguistics
- Interpret the fundamental concepts and major theories of psycholinguistics
- Use effective listening to apply principles of guidance and counselling
- Apply varied thoughts embedded in guidance and counselling approaches
- Defend and internalize Rwandan values
- Apply knowledge and skills acquired throughout the year to analyse factors influencing positive psychosocial and mental health behaviours among adolescent students and suggest practical solutions.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Social Psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to social and cultural Psychology	
Unit 1: Introduction to social psychology				Nº of Periods: 9
Key unit competence: Analyze how individual behavior is influenced by social contexts and interactions				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Explain the nature and scope of social psychology – Define concepts of social psychology – Identify the features of social behavior and thoughts – Describe the roles of social norms, social roles, and interpersonal relationships in shaping human behavior.	– Analyze real-life situations using principles of social psychology – Apply social Psychology concepts to evaluate social roles, norms, and interpersonal relationships within different social settings.	– Value the importance of positive social interaction and ethical behavior in daily life. – Demonstrate empathy and understanding toward people affected by prejudice and discrimination.	– Meaning and scope of social psychology – Key concepts of social Psychology (prejudice, stereotypes, discrimination, emotion, obedience, social influence, social perception, social behavior) – Social roles, norms and relationship	– In groups, students read handouts about nature and scope of Social Psychology and share their understanding – Students work in pairs to match key social Psychology terms with examples. – On a roundtable, students discuss how social Psychology principles (like empathy or social influence) can help solve small community problems (e.g., bullying, exclusion). – In groups, students read a short text on social norms and relationships and summarize the main points into their own words.

- Discuss the importance of social Psychology in understanding and improving real-life situations such as teamwork, conflict resolution, and community life.	- Differentiate positive and negative social behaviors (e.g., cooperation vs. prejudice). - Illustrate through examples how social roles and norms shape behavior and relationships in groups or communities.	- Develop openness and respect toward people from diverse social backgrounds. - Display collaboration and teamwork during group discussions and social interactions.	- Importance of social Psychology in real life	- In small groups, students perform short skits demonstrating social influence, obedience, or stereotypes, followed by class discussion. - In pairs, students prepare a short presentation on the importance of social Psychology in everyday life (e.g., relationships, education, media, workplace).
Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Art and Humanities.				
Assessment criteria: Students can explain how social Psychology shapes individual's behavior in various social contexts with relevant examples.				
Teaching and learning materials: Handouts on scope and nature of social psychology, videos, photos and printed case studies, internet				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages	
Topic Area: Social Psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to Social and cultural psychology		
Unit 2: Theories of social psychology				Nº of Periods: 12	
Key unit competence: Judge different views of social psychologists about human behaviour formation and change.					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
– Outline prominent theories in Social Psychology – Describe key theories of Social Psychology – Identify similarities and differences among social theories. – Describe how each theory explains individual behavior in social contexts.	– Justify how different theories interpret human behavior – Evaluate views coined in different theories of Social Psychology. – Analyze social situations using concepts from the major theories of social psychology – Assess underlying reasons behind theories of Social Psychology.	– Value the contribution of Social Psychology theories to the human being real life – Value the importance of positive social identity and supportive environments in language learning.	– Attribution theory – Social facilitation theory – Social identity theory – Self-determination theory – Implication of theories of social Psychology to language learning	– In groups, students read about the theories of Social Psychology in textbooks or internet and present the findings in plenary. – In pairs, students assess the nature of each theory in their respective groups – In pairs, students dress on a table illustrating similarities, differences, and unique contributions of major social theories.	

– Explain the implications of social Psychology theories for language learning and classroom interaction.	– Apply the social theories to explain language learning behaviors (e.g., group participation, motivation, self-perception).	– Demonstrate commitment to self-motivation, fairness, and responsibility in both individual and group learning contexts, based on the understanding of the theories.		– On a roundtable, students discuss examples of how social identity affects language use (e.g., accents, dialects, language choice). – Individually, students write about how their own identity (culture, language, or community) influences their confidence and motivation to learn another language.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Art and Humanities, Languages Subjects.

Assessment criteria: Students can comment critically the key theories of social Psychology by providing real-life examples.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials about different Social Psychology theories, internet, etc.

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Social Psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Group dynamics	
Unit 3: Introduction to group dynamics				Nº of Periods: 12
Key unit competence: Assess group phenomenon and their effect on people's behavior				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Define different types of groups (formal, informal, primary, secondary, etc.). – Explain different factors which influence group formation. – Explain the characteristics and patterns of group behaviour. – Describe factors that affect group behaviour, such as roles, norms, status, size, and communication.	– Demonstrate effective leadership and teamwork skills in group tasks. – Use appropriate strategies to manage and resolve inter-group conflicts.	– Appreciate the importance of cooperation, communication, and mutual respect in group settings. – Develop a positive attitude toward teamwork and shared responsibility. – Show tolerance and empathy towards diverse group members and viewpoints.	– Types of groups and factors influencing group formation – Group behaviour – Factors affecting group behaviour – Model social group development	– In pairs, students list different types of groups they belong to (family, study group, club, online community, etc.) and classify them as <i>formal/informal</i> or <i>primary/secondary</i>. – In groups students discuss factors influencing group formation and present in classroom. – In small groups, students discuss the purpose and characteristics of each group type. – Students create a visual diagram of the stages of group development with key features.

– Describe different leadership styles and their influence on group performance and cohesion. – Explain the causes of inter-group conflicts and discuss methods of conflict resolution. – Discuss how group dynamics influence learning, particularly in collaborative or language-learning contexts.	– Facilitate collaborative learning activities, promoting positive group interaction in language learning environments.	– Value constructive conflict resolution as a means of improving group performance. – Recognize the role of group interaction in enhancing learning, especially language learning.	– Group leadership and influence – Inter-group conflicts and inter-group conflict resolution – Group dynamics and language learning	– Students watch a short video in groups, identify factors affecting group behavior and do presentation of summarized findings. – Students practice different leadership styles in guiding a small group task, then discuss which was most effective. – Students practice mediation techniques or negotiation in simulated conflict scenarios. – Individually, students write about how working in groups helps improve speaking, listening, and social interaction skills. – In groups, students prepare a short presentation on the importance of understanding group dynamics in everyday life.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Literature in English, Psychology for Art and Humanities.

Assessment criteria: Students can evaluate how group phenomena affect human behavior with clear examples

Teaching and learning materials: Books, audio-visual material, flip chart, flashcards, markers

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages	
Topic Area: Social Psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Cross cultural psychology		
Unit 4: Introduction to cross cultural Psychology and Rwandan values				No of Periods: 8	
Key unit competence: Explore how culture influences behavior, communication, and interpretation of language across cultures.					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
– Explain culture and its role in shaping human behaviour and thoughts. – Describe key cultural dimensions and their influence on behaviour. – Explain the differences between verbal and non-verbal communication across cultures.	– Compare and contrast cultural behaviours and cultural values using examples from different societies. – Interpret verbal and non-verbal cues accurately in cross-cultural interactions. – Communicate effectively and respectfully with people from diverse cultural backgrounds.	– Develop respect and openness toward cultural diversity and differences. – Show empathy and tolerance in intercultural communication and relationships. – Value multilingualism as a means of connecting across cultures.	– Understanding culture – Cultural dimensions and behavior (individualism vs. collectivism, power distance, uncertainty avoidance) – Verbal and Non-verbal Communication across cultures – Language, identity, and multilingualism	– Individually, students brainstorm ideas about culture – In pairs, students analyse short stories about cultural influence, and share their findings – Through interactive presentations, students explore cultural dimensions and compare cultures using charts – Students watch videos of intercultural communication, act out greetings and gestures from different cultures and complete a matching exercise on non-verbal cues	

– Discuss the relationship between language, identity, and multilingualism in cross-cultural settings. – Identify stereotypes and cultural misunderstandings.	– Analyze real-life cases of cultural misunderstandings and propose constructive solutions. – Apply knowledge of cultural Psychology to promote inclusion and cooperation in multicultural contexts.	– Demonstrate a positive attitude toward learning from other cultures and challenging stereotypes. – Promote peaceful and cooperative interaction in multicultural environments.	– Stereotypes and cultural misunderstandings – Rwandan values	– In groups, students discuss how language relates to identity and present their findings – In pairs, students analyse stories of cultural stereotypes and misunderstandings, discuss their causes, and propose possible solutions. – Students debate on individualism versus collectivism. – Students write reflections on how Rwandan values shape Rwandese behaviour.
Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Literature in English, Psychology for Art and Humanities.				
Assessment criteria: Students can describe how culture influences behavior and communication and identify stereotypes with ways to overcome them.				
Teaching and learning materials: Books, audio-visual material, flip chart, flashcards, markers, written short stories, textbooks				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages	
Topic Area: Psychology of Language			Sub-Topic Area: Psycholinguistics		
Unit 5: Introduction to psycholinguistics				No of Periods: 12	
Key unit competence: Analyze basics of psycholinguistics					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
– Define key concepts related to psycholinguistics. – Explain the scope and subfields of psycholinguistics – Describe the key stages of language development in humans. – Discuss nature vs. nurture debate in language acquisition.	– Apply key concepts of psycholinguistics by analyzing how individuals acquire, comprehend, and produce language. – Discuss psycholinguistic topics effectively in oral or written form. – Compare and contrast different theories of language acquisition using evidence from research.	– Show curiosity and openness toward the study of language and the mind. – Appreciate the complexity of human language processing and acquisition.	– Key concepts of psycholinguistics (Language acquisition, Language comprehension, Language production, Mental lexicon, Speech perception, Language processing, First language (L1), Second language (L 2). – Scope and subfields psycholinguistics.	– Through think-pair-share, students brainstorm the meaning psycholinguistics – In groups, students create a concept map linking key ideas (language, mind, brain, communication). – In groups, students conduct group research on different subfields of psycholinguistics and present their findings – Students watch videos showing stages of language development and in groups, create a timeline of language acquisition.	

– Identify and explain the main areas of the brain involved in language functions. – Distinguish between first and second language acquisition processes – Describe common research methods used in psycholinguistic studies. – Explain the applications and current trends of psycholinguistics in education, language learning, and communication.	– Use knowledge of language and the brain to identify and explain how cognitive and neural processes support language processing, speech perception, and the organization of the mental lexicon.	– Respect diversity in languages among individuals. – Demonstrate collaboration and ethical conduct when engaging in group discussions or research activities.	– Key stages of language development. – Nature vs. nurture in language acquisition. – Language and the brain – First language acquisition – Second language acquisition – Research methods in psycholinguistics – Applications and trends of psycholinguistics	– In pairs, students label language-related brain areas on diagrams. – In groups, students engage in a debate on the topic: "Is language innate or learned?" – In small groups, students compare their second language learning experiences. – In pairs, students design a simple survey about language use and present findings to the class. – Individually, students write a reflection essay on the relevance of psycholinguistics to real life.
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Link to other subjects: Languages Subjects, Psychology for Art and Humanities.

Assessment criteria: Students can explain key psycholinguistic concepts and link language acquisition to the brain development and environment

Teaching and learning materials: Books, audio-visual material, flip chart, flashcards, markers, **transcripts of** children's speech

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Psychology of Language			Sub-Topic Area: Psycholinguistics	
Unit 6: Introduction to language processing and acquisition				No of Periods: 13
Key unit competence: Interpret the fundamental concepts and major theories of psycholinguistics				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Describe the main processes involved in language comprehension and language production. – Identify and explain the mechanisms that underlie language learning. – Distinguish major theories of language acquisition (behaviorist, nativist, interactionist, connectionist).	– Compare and contrast different theories of language acquisition in relation to first and second language learning. – Interpret findings from current psycholinguistic research and discuss their implications for language learning. – Apply theoretical knowledge to real-life language learning contexts (e.g., classroom, bilingual settings).	– Demonstrate curiosity and openness toward interdisciplinary approaches to studying language. – Show appreciation for scientific research on how humans acquire and process language. – Value the importance of understanding individual differences in language learning and processing.	– Meaning and scope of language processing – Language comprehension – Language production – Mechanisms of language learning – Theories of language acquisition	– Individually, students brainstorm the understanding of language processing and acquisition – Students watch short video explaining how the brain processes language and in groups, summarize what they have seen – In groups, students participate in guided discussions about different theories of language acquisition (e.g., behaviorist, innatism, interactionist).

– Describe recent trends and research in the field of language acquisition and processing. – Explain how cognitive and neurological processes support human communication.	– Use critical thinking to discuss how brain mechanisms influence language use and learning.	– Exhibit respect for diverse linguistic backgrounds and perspectives in discussions on language acquisition.	– Current trends and research in language acquisition	– In groups, students create a concept map showing the relationship between comprehension, production, and learning mechanisms. – In pairs, students role-play communication situations to observe real-time language processing (listening, speaking, and correcting).
Link to other subjects: Languages Subjects, Psychology for Art and Humanities.				
Assessment criteria: Students explain clearly the processes of language and relate theoretical perspectives to real-life language learning and communication contexts.				
Teaching and learning materials: Books, audio-visual material, flip chart, flashcards, markers				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages	
Topic Area: Counseling psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Guidance and counseling		
Unit 7: Introduction to guidance and counseling				No of Periods: 12	
Key unit competence: Use effective listening to apply principles of guidance and counselling.					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
– Define the concepts related to guidance and counseling – Identify types of guidance and counseling – Describe the principles of guidance and counseling – Explain techniques and phases of counseling	– Apply counselling principles and techniques in simulated contexts – Analyze case examples to identify appropriate guidance or counseling approaches. – Use basic listening and communication skills required in counseling.	– Appreciate the importance of guidance and counseling in promoting personal growth and well-being. – Show open-mindedness when dealing with diverse individuals and issues. – Valuing everyone’s dignity and uniqueness.	– Key concepts in guidance and counselling (guidance, counselling, Counsellor, therapy) – Types of guidance and counselling – Principles of guidance and counselling – Effective counselling techniques – Phases/steps of counselling	– In pairs, students share ideas related to the concepts of guidance and counseling – In groups, students create a graphic organizer for types of guidance and counseling, including their focus, examples, and strategies. – In groups, students participate in role-plays simulating counselling sessions where they take turns acting as the counsellor and the client – In pairs, students classify the principles of guidance and counseling – Through think-pair- share, students identify effective counseling techniques	

– Identify challenges in guidance and counselling – Outline qualities of a good counselor		– Commit to ethical and responsible behavior in counseling situations. – Internalize the spirit of helping others.	– Basic communication skills and qualities of a good counsellor – Challenges in guidance and counselling	– Students practice basic counseling skills (listening, questioning, empathy) in pairs – Students work in small groups to analyze short case studies involving guidance and counselling challenges (e.g., exam anxiety, career choice dilemmas, family problems, etc.) – On a roundtable, the whole class discusses the roles of guidance and counseling in schools and communities. – In groups, students debate ethical dilemmas in counseling (confidentiality, impartiality, respect). – Individually, students write about the importance of guidance and counseling
Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Psychology for Art and Humanities.				
Assessment criteria: Students, through simulation, apply principles and techniques of guidance and counseling				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials guidance and counseling, internet,				

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages
Topic Area: Counseling psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Guidance and counseling	
Unit 8: Key theories and approaches of counseling				No of Periods: 12
Key unit competence: Apply varied thoughts embedded in guidance and counselling approaches				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
– Explain the major principles of key counseling theories – Describe effective counseling approaches at individual and group levels – Explain similarities and differences among counseling theories	– Compare and contrast the major counseling approaches in terms of their goals, techniques, and views of human behavior. – Apply, in simulated way, the counseling approaches accurately towards people suffering from psychological disorders.	– Value the use of appropriate counseling approaches depending on the level and severity of mental illness – Respect everyone's inner thoughts, emotions, and experiences – Demonstrate care and compassion in interpersonal relationships.	– Psychoanalytic theory – Behavioral approaches – Client centered therapy – Holistic approaches – Family systems therapy	– In small groups, Students read handouts about theories of counseling and share findings – In groups, students classify and discuss the advantages and disadvantages of selected counseling approaches – Students read short case scenarios describing individuals facing psychological or social issues, in groups identify suggest possible counselling approaches or interventions. – Students familiarize themselves through role plays about the use of counseling approaches

– Explain the relevance and application of these theories to contemporary counseling practice.	– Link counseling theory to real-life emotional or family situations.	– Value balance, harmony, and holistic approaches to problem-solving – Develop a positive attitude toward continuous learning and professional growth in counseling.	– On a roundtable, students discuss why the counselor is called a facilitator rather than a director. – In groups, students debate on which counseling approach is most effective for different client issues. – Individually, write a reflection on how theories of counseling can help counselors support clients.
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Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Languages Subjects, Psychology for Art and Humanities.

Assessment criteria: Students, through simulation activities, apply theories and approaches of guidance and counseling to effectively manage psychosocial issues.

Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials, textbooks, internet

Subject: Psychology		Senior Six		Pathway: Languages	
Topic Area: Health psychology			Sub-Topic Area: Introduction to health psychology		
Unit 9: Introduction to health psychology				Nº of Periods: 9	
Key unit competence: Assess how individuals have control over their health and helping them make better choices of wellness					
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities	
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values			
– Define health and health psychology – Explain the importance of learning health psychology – Describe factors that influence health behaviors, – Explain the concept of positive health behaviors and their impact on well-being.	– Compare and contrast factors that influence health psychology – Evaluate personal and peer health behaviors and suggest evidence-based improvements. – Justify the relevance of health Psychology in everyday life	– Show empathy and respect for individuals experiencing health challenges. – Internalize ways of preventing illness and managing them. – Value individual differences that may affect health psychology	– Key concepts of health psychology:(health psychology, wellness, prevention, health behavior change, therapy, intervention stress, depression.)	– Individually, students make a list of their own characteristics when they feel healthy – In groups, students make a concept map of health and health psychology – In pairs, students complete a matching exercise linking key concepts (e.g., health psychology, wellness, prevention, behavior change) with their definitions. – In pairs, students read handouts about models and factors influencing health Psychology and share their findings	

– Explain the consequences of unhealthy choices. – Describe the role of genetics and environment in health psychology – Explain different coping strategies for managing stress effectively. – Identify health-risk behaviors and their consequences on health.	– Judge real-life situations to identify health-risk behaviors and propose positive behavior changes – Apply stress assessment and coping strategies in simulated scenarios. – Sketch the relationship between psychological factors and physical health, showing how thoughts, emotions, and behaviors influence overall well-being.	– Make and practice better choices of wellness. – Develop a responsible attitude toward managing psychological and social issues. – Appreciate the importance of stress management and healthy lifestyle choices.	– Factors that influence health psychology – Health -risk behaviors – Positive health behaviors – Stress and coping strategies	– Students watch a video introducing health Psychology and in plenary, discuss its role in promoting well-being. – In groups, students discuss how illness affects health psychology – In groups, students create a mind map showing how psychological social factors influence health (e.g. stress, family support). – In pairs, students design a poster promoting healthy lifestyle practices. – Individually, students write an essay focusing on ways of minimizing illnesses that interfere with life roles and relationships
Link to other subjects: General and Religious Studies, Biology, Physical Education and Sports, Psychology for Art and Humanities.				
Assessment criteria: Students can evaluate factors that influence health Psychology and discuss how risk behaviors affect health Psychology				
Teaching and learning materials: Flip charts, markers, flash cards, handouts and audio-visual materials about health psychology, internet,				

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ANNEX

Subjects and Weekly Time Allocation for Upper Secondary Languages Pathway (S4-S6)

Subject	Number of periods		
I. Major Core subjects/ Examinable at National Level	(Period= 40 minutes)		
	S4	S5	S6
1. English	7	7	7
2. French	7	7	7
3. Kinyarwanda	7	7	7
4. Kiswahili	7	7	7
II. Minor Core Subjects/ Examinable at National Level			
5. History	3	3	3
6. Psychology	3	3	3
7. Basic Mathematics	3	3	3
Sub-total 1	37	37	37
III. General Subjects: Examinable at School level			
8. ICT	3	3	3
9. Entrepreneurship	3	3	3
10. General and religious Studies	3	3	3
11. Physical Education and Sports	2	2	2

Sub-total 2	11	11	11
III. Co-curricular activities (compulsory)	2	2	2
Total number of contact periods per week	50	50	50
Total number of contact hours/week	33.3	33.3	33.3
Total number of contact hours per year (39 weeks)	1300	1300	1300